



RCCG OCEANIA

Relationships

IDENTIFYING TRUE LOVE: LESSONS FROM AMNON

AT A GLANCE

BIG IDEA

In a world where emotions can be misleading, it's crucial to distinguish between true love and mere infatuation. The story of Amnon and Tamar in Second Samuel provides a powerful lesson on the dangers of mistaking obsession for love. By examining biblical principles, we can learn to identify the signs of genuine affection and avoid the pitfalls of superficial attraction.

PRIMARY PASSAGES

2 Samuel 13

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Not everything you feel is true love.
- A man's attention is a significant indicator of his love.
- Sex before marriage can obscure the understanding of true love.
- Introducing you to important people is a sign of genuine affection.
- Being protective and including you in future plans are signs of true love.

INTRODUCTION

In the quest to understand love, the story of Amnon and Tamar in Second Samuel offers profound insights. This narrative challenges us to discern between genuine love and mere infatuation, highlighting the importance of patience, respect, and true affection.

SCRIPTURE READING

- **2 Samuel 13** — Illustrates the difference between true love and obsession through the story of Amnon and Tamar.

KEY POINTS

1. **UNDERSTANDING TRUE LOVE** — True love is characterized by attention, patience, and inclusion in future plans. It is not driven by immediate gratification or superficial attraction. In the story of Amnon and Tamar, we see how Amnon's feelings were not rooted in genuine love but in a fleeting obsession. True love seeks the well-being of the other person and is willing to wait and invest in the relationship.
 - Reflect on your relationships and identify if they are based on genuine love or mere attraction.
 - Consider how you show attention and care to those you love.
 - Evaluate if your future plans include the well-being of your loved ones.

Scripture: 2 Samuel 13

KEY POINTS (CONT.)

2. THE DANGERS OF OBSESSION — Amnon's story shows how obsession can be mistaken for love, leading to destructive outcomes. His actions were driven by a desire for immediate gratification, which ultimately led to harm and regret. True love, in contrast, is patient and respectful, seeking the good of the other person above selfish desires.

- Identify any obsessive tendencies in your relationships and address them.
- Practice patience and respect in your interactions with loved ones.
- Seek guidance from Scripture to understand the nature of true love.

Scripture: 2 Samuel 13

KEY POINTS (CONT.)

3. **SIGNS OF GENUINE AFFECTION** — Genuine affection is shown through attention, protection, and investment in the relationship. These signs help distinguish true love from mere attraction. In the biblical narrative, we learn that true love involves introducing loved ones to important people, being protective, and including them in future plans.

- Assess how you demonstrate affection in your relationships.
- Ensure that your actions align with the principles of genuine love.
- Foster relationships that are built on mutual respect and care.

Scripture: 2 Samuel 13

GROUP DISCUSSION

Tip: Use these questions to guide the group from seeing → understanding → applying.

OBSERVATION

- What were the key differences between Amnon's feelings and true love?
- How did Amnon's actions reflect his misunderstanding of love?
- What role did Jonadab play in Amnon's decisions?
- How did Tamar respond to Amnon's advances?

INTERPRETATION

- Why is it important to distinguish between love and obsession?
- How can immediate gratification obscure true love?
- What lessons can we learn from Amnon's story about the consequences of mistaking obsession for love?

APPLICATION

- How can we apply the principles of true love in our relationships today?
- What steps can we take to ensure our relationships are based on genuine affection?
- How can we support others in recognizing the difference between true love and infatuation?

PRAYER FOCUS

- Pray for wisdom to discern between true love and infatuation in relationships.
- Ask for guidance in demonstrating genuine affection and care for others.
- Seek patience and respect in all interactions with loved ones.

NEXT STEP

Reflect on your relationships to ensure they are based on genuine love and not mere attraction.

CONCLUSION

The story of Amnon and Tamar serves as a cautionary tale about the dangers of mistaking obsession for love. By understanding the characteristics of true love, we can build relationships that are grounded in respect, patience, and genuine affection. Let us strive to embody these principles in our lives, ensuring that our love is true and enduring.